

Topic: How societal gender roles/norms show up in the things we read/create and how authors/creators can play with those norms to critique society through the same mediums.

Students: 10th Grade ELA class in an urban school, probably fairly diverse all around (I'm basing it off of my current placement of Dominion, but older).

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Also, we're scheduling for a block period (90 minutes) so I don't have to assume homework or a previous period in the scope of this lesson plan. Also, because why not.

Texts: Jackalope Wives by Ursula Vernon -

<https://www.apexbookcompany.com/a/blog/apex-magazine/post/jackalope-wives>

Swan Maiden Folktale - <https://sites.pitt.edu/~dash/swan.html> The 2nd story, from the Swedish Tradition

Content Standard	RL.9-10.9 Analyze how an author alludes to and transforms source material in a specific work (e.g., how Shakespeare treats a theme or topic from Ovid or the Bible or how a later author draws on a play by Shakespeare).
Objective Consider: Bloom's verbs (level of order of thinking) Consider: By statement (how students will practice the skill)	Example: Students will analyze gender roles by reading literary texts and making inferences about a culture through characterization. Students will identify the critique within a work by analyzing how authors play with gender roles and stereotypes.
Assessment	My assessment will be an exit ticket discussing take-aways from the lesson at the end of class. Criteria: 4-5 takeaways.
Opening	~10 Minutes: In the first 10 minutes, the students will read the Swedish version of the Swan Maiden. It'll start as quiet reading, and then they'll have some small group discussions along the following questions: - How is the man in this story presented? How is the woman? - What do you think this tells you about the society of the culture that this story came out of?

	They're probably a bit high level, but I think 10th graders could handle it. While they're doing so, I'm walking around after I take attendance or do some other non-important bullshit. ~10 minutes: We'll then talk about these things in a larger group, taking at least 1 answer from each group and having a bit of a discussion. I want to highlight on specific threads of conversation that I'm hearing and what I heard walking around. I also recap/review what gender norms are and what they could possibly say about a society. I could have slides, but something tells me that 10th graders have been alive long enough to kind of get a sense at what the world is like around them.
Instruction What are the skills? What are the strategies to help with the skills? HOW are you teaching the skill?	~20 minutes: We're reading the Jackalope Wives. I'll probably start by reading aloud the first page, pointing out the immediate similarities between this and the Swan maiden story, as well as its differences. This is probably going to be more prompting for me to get some answers from the students. I also want to define some terms like Saguro and Jackalope. After doing that for a few, quiet reading for the most part. At the end, I'll answer any questions about the text and prepare the students for our next activity after break. ~10 minutes: Break. It's a long period. Towards the end, I'm going to mix up the groups with popsicle sticks ~ 30 minutes: Coming back from break, we get into the meat of the lesson. Now that everyone has read the Jackalope Wives, we'll start by comparing and contrasting how the two texts represent both genders. This is better as a big group, I think and I'll draw a big chart on the board and write things down in it. Then among the groups, the students will talk about why these differences and similarities exist. I'll focus them towards thinking about the cultural question here, about what these texts say about the cultures they're brought up within. I can also stand at each group and listen in for a few minutes each, maybe injecting some ideas into the conversation or making sure students are on track. We won't come back together for this one, but I'll shift the conversation towards this question: What decisions is Ursula Vernon making when it comes to portraying men and women? What critiques is she making about our society? I think this needs to be half and half group and whole class discussion. The main points that I want to make sure are addressed are: - Why the author might make those decisions and how they are contributing to their society.

	- What Grandma Harken means at the end of the story when she says “It’s different when you got a choice”. - Does Jackalope Wives suggest new gender norms, or something different? - What it means overall to be of a binary gender in society, focusing on women but including men and privilege. After all this, which should be a half hour, I’ll close by asking the students to use this text and their discussions as mentors for their own creative project. They’re getting a lot of freedom to saying something that they care about, but that comes with great responsibility (Uncle Ben, 1962)
Worksheet / Handout / Materials	- Two texts listed above. - Tables, chairs - popsicle sticks - Whiteboard
Closure	~10 minutes: The last 10 minutes are reserved for the take-aways exit ticket. I want 4-5 observations, ideas, or take-aways handed to me at the end of class. It might be on a loose sheet of paper or in their hypothetical writing notebooks. I want this section to at least start out quiet, as they’ve just had a lot of active time and probably need some settling.
Alignment	I think this lesson is purposefully open, because open-ness leads to better critical consciousness. I could be more direct on the systems I think we’re talking about here, but I also want the students to see that their voice is just as important as mine and that they can use it, which discussions facilitates.